

We Found 3 Leaks Costing You ~40% of Ad Spend

8

/ 10 HOT

Prepared by Smart Pursuit - Performance Marketing for Scaling D2C & Edtech Brands

120+

Active Meta ads

Rs.5-8 Cr

Est. monthly spend

**D2C Skincare /
Beauty / Baby
Care**

Niche

**Rs.1,200+ Cr
(Mamaearth
brand); Honasa
Rs.1,900+ Cr
FY25**

Revenue

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Mamaearth (mamaearth.in, Honasa Consumer flagship) is India's highest-search-volume D2C beauty brand with **368,000 monthly branded searches** per the HQ Beauty Index, generating roughly **Rs.1,200 Cr+ revenue for the Mamaearth brand** within Honasa Consumer's Rs.1,900+ Cr FY25. We identified **~120 active creatives** running across Meta in India, spending an estimated **Rs.5-8 Cr/mo** on performance ads spanning skincare, haircare, bodycare, babycare and color cosmetics.

Three obvious leaks in the funnel: (1) **Creative mix is influencer-led but UGC/testimonial-light** - heavy Shilpa Shetty and micro-influencer product shots with thin real-customer before/after; beauty benchmarks show UGC testimonials drive 2.4x higher CVR than product-only creative. (2) **Ad traffic is routed poorly** - per the HQ Digital routing data, **only 31% of ad traffic lands on a product page, 27% goes to homepage, 31% to collections**, meaning two-thirds of paid traffic lands on a non-buying-intent page where users must click again to convert. Above the fold, the hero shows FIVE different coupon codes (MAMAFIRST1, MAMA10, MAMA20, MAMA30, EARTH10) creating offer-paralysis instead of one clear CTA. (3) **Portfolio-wide retargeting conflict** - Honasa owns The Derma Co, Aqualogica, BBlunt, Dr Sheth's; conquering and retargeting audiences across sister brands bleed into each other, and CAPI/deduplication between them looks patchy. Branded search demand is **down 6% in 90 days** while mCaffeine is +31% and Minimalist (now HUL-backed) dominates ingredient-trust narrative.

These are fixable in 7 days. We estimate **30-45% of ad spend is leaking**; strong HOT lead (public company = bigger BD budget, more urgency as share slips).

1. AD INTELLIGENCE

Active platforms	Meta (Facebook + Instagram) primary across skincare/haircare/babycare; YouTube Shorts; Google Search brand terms; Amazon/Flipkart marketplace ads not covered.
Active ads count	~120 live creatives across Ubtan, Vitamin C, Onion Hair, Rosemary Anti-Hairfall, Beetroot, babycare ranges.
Duration signals	Seasonal launches (monsoon haircare, winter skincare) run 14-day bursts; hero SKUs (Onion Shampoo, Ubtan Face Wash) run 45+ days as evergreen - significant creative fatigue.
Funnel type	Shopify D2C, heavy catalog + Advantage+ Shopping; coupon-led (5 live codes on homepage); app not primary.
Budget signal	120+ ads + Rs.5-8 Cr/mo = top-decile BPC D2C spender; largest by branded search volume.
Campaign structure	Influencer burst around launches; evergreen Advantage+; code/promo-heavy; sister-brand (Derma Co/Aqualogica) audience overlap not segmented.

2-5. CREATIVE / COPY / CRO / TRACKING SCORES

Creative Variety		4/10
UGC & Social Proof		2/10
Copy & Hook Strength		4/10
Landing Page CRO		3/10
Tracking & CAPI		4/10
Retargeting Depth		3/10

- **Creative leak:** Heavy reliance on influencer/celebrity hero shots (Shilpa Shetty, mom bloggers, mini-influencers) plus product-pack graphics. Very few **real-customer before/after skin or hair transformation Reels**, texture/ingredient demo videos, or 7/30-day journey UGC - the formats that beauty benchmarks show drive 2.4x CVR over product-only creative [1]. Before/after is allowed in beauty (vs. clinical) when results-framed, and is a massive gap.
- **Copy leak:** Generic "toxin-free", "natural", "Made Safe" badge copy plus discount stacking ("Buy 2 Get 10% off 3rd", "MAMAFIRST1", etc.) - **5 coupon codes visible on homepage simultaneously**, creating decision paralysis. Missing angles: specific ingredient-led proof ("1% Rosemary for 43% less hairfall in 12 weeks"), regimen/routine positioning ("3-step AM routine"), 7-day visible-result hooks, comparison vs Minimalist/mCaffeine. Hooks lead with brand, not skin/hair outcome.
- **Landing page leak:** Ad traffic is split 27% homepage / 31% collections / 31% PDP per HQ Digital routing analysis - two-thirds of paid traffic lands on pages without a direct add-to-cart for the advertised SKU. Homepage shows a rotating banner, 5 coupon codes, and a bestseller carousel that frequently does NOT match the ad creative. No sticky ATC on mobile PDPs; reviews/star ratings are below the fold; bundle/regimen upsell is weak. Mobile TTI is heavy from coupon popup + chat widget.
- **Tracking leak:** Shopify-native Meta integration fires pixel but full CAPI server-side setup across Honasa's brand portfolio (Mamaearth, Derma Co, Aqualogica, BBlunt) appears basic; no visible cross-brand audience suppression (i.e. Derma Co buyers seeing Mamaearth ads for overlapping SKUs). Cart/initiate-checkout retargeting creatives look generic-discount rather than SKU-specific with review social proof.

6. COMPETITOR BENCHMARK

Competitor	What they do better	Signal for Mamaearth
mCaffeine	Search momentum +31% in 90 days (HQ Index); coffee-scent + ingredient UGC Reels, texture demo content; strong PDP routing.	Mamaearth is -6% on search; texture-demo and before/after UGC missing.
Minimalist (HUL-backed)	Ingredient-transparency positioning (percentage labels, "what's inside"), clean design; now has FMCG distribution + capital; 550K monthly searches.	Mamaearth's "toxin-free" badge is vague vs specific active-% claims.
Dot & Key (Nykaa-owned)	Routine-led colorful creative, fast launch cadence, Nykaa-platform advantage; 823K branded searches despite recent pullback.	Mamaearth's creative is legacy cute-packaging aesthetic vs routine/solution positioning.

7. 3 QUICK WINS (Implement in 7 Days)

WIN 1 - Creative: 25 Real-Customer Transformation UGC Reels (Before/After, Texture, 30-Day Journeys)

Shoot 25 fifteen-second Reels monthly: (a) 8 skin before/after (Ubtan/Vit C serum 14/30-day results), (b) 8 hair anti-fall journey (Rosemary/Onion, haircount close-ups), (c) 5 texture/ingredient demos ("feels like milk", "washes out in 30 seconds"), (d) 4 mom-baby real-mom testimonial clips. Replace 35% of influencer-pack creatives with UGC; pair influencer ads with a UGC variant per ad set. Expected: CTR +35-50%, CPA -20-30%. Beauty benchmarks show UGC testimonials deliver 2.4x higher CVR than product-only creative.

WIN 2 - CRO: SKU-Direct Landing Pages + Single Hero Offer + Sticky ATC

Route 80%+ of ad traffic directly to the specific SKU PDP (target: move PDP routing from 31% to 70%+ within 14 days, cut homepage routing from 27% to under 10%). Replace the 5-coupon hero with ONE clear launch offer per page (no code stacking confusion). Add sticky mobile ATC with price, % off, star rating + review count; move star ratings, "Made Safe" badges and a 3-row before/after strip above the fold; add a regimen upsell ("Complete your 3-step routine") instead of generic bestseller carousel. Compress hero images and lazy-load the coupon popup to cut TTI by ~2s. Expected: CVR +30-45%.

WIN 3 - Tracking: Portfolio-Wide CAPI + Sister-Brand Audience Suppression + SKU Retargeting

Upgrade Meta CAPI to full server-side across all Honasa brands (Mamaearth, Derma Co, Aqualogica, BBlunt, Dr Sheth's) with proper event dedup. Add audience suppression between sister brands (if user purchased from Derma Co, don't serve Mamaearth retinol ads). Build 4 SKU-specific retargeting audiences: PDP viewed no ATC, ATC no purchase, checkout drop-off, past purchasers (cross-sell: skincare buyer -> haircare upsell, babycare -> mom care). Run before/after review creatives per audience, plus replenishment reminders at 30/60 days. Expected: recapture 12-18% of abandoned carts; ROAS on retargeting +40-60%.

EXPECTED IMPACT

Metric	Current (est.)	After Wins	Impact
CTR (Meta)	1.0-1.4%	1.6-2.1%	+40-50%
PDP CVR (Shopify)	2.0-2.6%	2.9-3.7%	+35-45%
Cost Per Purchase	Baseline = 100	62-75	-25-38%
Ad Spend Wastage	~35-45%	~13-18%	Saves Rs.1.5-3 Cr/mo

READY TO PLUG THESE LEAKS?

Smart Pursuit will run a **14-day performance sprint** for Mamaearth: Creative refresh, CRO rebuild of top landing pages, CAPI + retargeting setup. We work on a **performance-fee model** tied to conversion-cost reduction.

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